

Installing EpisodeSleuth on Linux

This guide covers installing **EpisodeSleuth** (the phonetic dialogue fingerprinting system) on a 64-bit Linux machine. No programming experience required.

There are two ways to install, from easiest to most involved:

Option	Best for	Needs Python?
A. Standalone package (recommended)	Just running the app	No
B. Source install (pip)	Developers, or running from source	Yes

The only external tool the standalone app still needs at run time is **FFmpeg** (for decoding audio):

```
sudo apt install ffmpeg      # Debian / Ubuntu / Mint
sudo dnf install ffmpeg      # Fedora
sudo pacman -S ffmpeg        # Arch
```

Option A: Standalone package (recommended, no Python)

This is the simplest path. You get a self-contained app - no Python, no `pip`, no virtual environment.

You can install from either the `.tar.gz` (works on any distro) or, on Debian/Ubuntu, the `.deb`.

A1: From the .tar.gz (any distro)

1. Get **EpisodeSleuth-<version>-linux-x64.tar.gz** (from the project's Releases, or build it yourself with `./package_linux.sh` - see [BUILD_EXECUTABLES.md](#)).

2. Extract it:

```
bash
tar -xzf EpisodeSleuth-<version>-linux-x64.tar.gz
cd EpisodeSleuth-<version>-linux-x64
```

3. Install:

```
bash
./install.sh      # installs for the current user (~/.local)
sudo ./install.sh # installs system-wide (/opt, on PATH for everyone)
```

Or skip installing and just run it in place:

```
bash
./EpisodeSleuth/EpisodeSleuth
```

4. After installing, launch **EpisodeSleuth** from your desktop application menu, or run `episodesleuth` in a terminal.

To uninstall (match the scope you installed with):

```
./uninstall.sh          # or: sudo ./uninstall.sh
```

If `~/local/bin` is not on your `PATH`, the installer prints a note. Add it to your shell profile, or launch from the app menu instead.

A2: From the .deb (Debian / Ubuntu)

```
sudo apt install ./episodesleuth_<version>_amd64.deb
```

This installs into `/opt/episodesleuth`, adds an `episodesleuth` command on `PATH`, and creates an application-menu entry. `ffmpeg` is pulled in automatically as a dependency. Remove it with:

```
sudo apt remove episodesleuth
```

Option B: Source install (developers)

Use this if you want to run from source with your own Python, or you are developing EpisodeSleuth.

1. Install prerequisites

```
sudo apt install python3 python3-venv python3-pip ffmpeg # Debian/Ubuntu
```

2. Create a virtual environment and install packages

From the project folder:

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs PySide6-Fluent-Widgets (the GUI toolkit), Vosk (speech-to-text), Double Metaphone (phonetic encoding), and other dependencies.

3. Download the Vosk speech model

The offline speech-to-text engine needs a language model. Either download it from the app's **Settings** page on first run, or fetch it manually:

1. Download: <https://alphacephei.com/vosk/models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15.zip>
2. Extract so you get a folder `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`
3. Move it into the project's `models/` directory:
`models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15/`

Running the app

- **Standalone (Option A):** launch **EpisodeSleuth** from your app menu, or run `episodesleuth` in a terminal.
- **Source install (Option B) - GUI:** `python -m audio_fingerprint.gui`
- **Source install (Option B) - CLI:**
`python -m audio_fingerprint.cli.identify --dir "/path/to/dvd_rips"`

See [README.md](#) and [USAGE_DVD.md](#) for full usage.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
<code>ffmpeg</code> not found	Install it: <code>sudo apt install ffmpeg</code> (or your distro's package manager)
<code>episodesleuth</code> command not found	Add <code>~/.local/bin</code> to your <code>PATH</code> , or install system-wide with <code>sudo ./install.sh</code>
Vosk model errors	Open Settings and download the model, or check the model folder exists
"speech-to-text module could not be loaded"	Standalone: re-download the package (older builds missed the STT deps); Source: <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again
App menu entry missing	Log out/in, or run <code>update-desktop-database ~/.local/share/applications</code>
GUI won't start (source install)	Re-run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> to ensure PySide6-Fluent-Widgets is installed